

DEBT & EQUITY

Fannie Mae's \$163M Refi Shows Multifamily Debt Is Available, but Only for the Right Sponsor and Basis

LaSalle's refinancing signals that agency liquidity is flowing to stabilized assets with credible sponsors and conservative leverage.

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A prudent credit committee reviewing a \$163 million Fannie Mae refinancing for an 833-unit multifamily portfolio would ask one question first: Why does this borrower need agency debt at this moment, and what does the structure reveal about the market?

The answer is not that multifamily lending is back. It is that agency debt is available for a narrow set of conditions: stabilized assets, a sponsor with institutional credibility, and a structure that keeps leverage conservative enough to survive another year of expensive money.

LaSalle Investment Management, the real estate investment arm of Jones Lang LaSalle, has secured a \$163 million Fannie Mae-backed loan from Newmark to refinance three properties in Washington, D.C., Falls Church, Va., and Hillsboro, Ore. The debt was arranged by Newmark's Jordan Roeschlaub, Christopher Kramer, Aaron Golesorkhi, and Capri Van Gilder. The portfolio includes 14W Apartments in D.C., Pearson Square in Northern Virginia, and Nexus at Orenco Station in Oregon.

The transaction refinances LaSalle's existing cross-collateralized Fannie Mae credit facility while also enabling the borrower to add collateral in the future, according to Newmark. The firm described the deal as providing "long-term financing while maintaining conservative leverage and strong credit metrics."

The most revealing detail is not the loan amount or the portfolio size. It is the structure: a cross-collateralized facility that LaSalle can expand. That feature tells the market that Fannie Mae is willing to grow its relationship with this sponsor, not just refinance existing exposure. It signals that the agency sees LaSalle as a counterparty with enough balance-sheet credibility to underwrite additional assets without demanding a full new underwriting process.

That is not true for every borrower. Agency debt is not a commodity right now. It is a relationship product. Fannie Mae's DUS lenders are allocating capital to sponsors they know,

assets they have already underwritten, and structures that limit their downside. The market is not rewarding optimism. It is rewarding structure.

The portfolio's geographic diversity also matters. Washington, D.C., Northern Virginia, and suburban Portland are not the same market. But they share a common characteristic: each has a multifamily supply pipeline that is manageable relative to demand. The agency is not financing construction risk or lease-up risk. It is financing cash-flowing assets in markets where vacancy and rent growth are predictable enough to underwrite.

That is the capital pressure underneath the headline. Fannie Mae is not solving the multifamily cycle. It is deciding who gets enough time to survive it. For sponsors with maturing debt, the question is not whether agency liquidity exists. It is whether their assets, leverage, and sponsor track record meet the agency's current underwriting standard.

LaSalle's deal also reveals something about the private market. If a sponsor of this size and quality is using agency debt, it suggests that bank balance sheets remain constrained and that private-label CMBS is not yet pricing competitively for this kind of stabilized portfolio. The agency is the most efficient source of long-term, fixed-rate capital for multifamily, and that advantage has widened as bank lending has pulled back.

The borrower's constraint changed with this transaction. LaSalle now has a longer maturity runway, a known cost of capital, and the option to add collateral without renegotiating the entire facility. That is a meaningful improvement in liquidity and optionality. The lender's constraint also changed: Fannie Mae has added a known quantity to its book at terms that protect against downside, but it has also increased its exposure to a single sponsor and a set of assets that will face refinancing risk again when this loan matures.

For owners with maturing multifamily debt, the lesson is specific. Agency liquidity is available, but it is not evenly distributed. It is flowing to sponsors who can demonstrate balance-sheet strength, assets with defensible cash flow, and leverage that does not require heroic assumptions about rent growth or cap rate compression. The market is not rewarding the best

The next test for the market is whether this kind of refinancing becomes more common or remains concentrated among a small group of institutional sponsors. If Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac continue to lend at this pace, the agency channel will become the primary refinancing outlet for stabilized multifamily, and the gap between sponsors who can access it and those who cannot will widen. That gap is where distress lives.

LaSalle's refinancing is not proof that the multifamily market has healed. It is proof that the right sponsor, the right basis, and the right structure still clear. The rest of the market is still waiting for its turn.